

Alistair Tran

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Seasoned developer and leader with 8+ years of experience creating fan-favorite games.

Education

UNIVERSITY OF CALIFORNIA SANTA CRUZ

Studying for a Bachelor of Science Degree in Computer Science: Computer Game Design.

Santa Cruz, CA

Expected Graduation Jun 2028

UNIVERSITY OF CALIFORNIA LOS ANGELES

Enrolled and completed in the NSLC Video Game Design Program.

Los Angeles, CA

Completed Jul 2023

DUBLIN HIGH SCHOOL

Graduated with Academic Block D and Honor Roll.

Dublin, CA

Graduated Jun 2025

Experience

WRITING DEPARTMENT HEAD

Game Development and Art Collaboration

- Helping run a student-led game studio with 200+ contributors through the production of a game from pitch to release.
- Greatly restructured department to welcome 30+ new students and get more developers interested in game writing, a record increase from previous years.
- Hosting weekly workshops to aid ambitious students with career opportunities, writing technique, and public speaking.

Santa Cruz, CA

Jun 2026 - Ongoing

PROGRAMMING PRODUCER

Game Development and Art Collaboration

- Helping run a student-led game studio with 200+ contributors through the production of a game from pitch to release.
- Delegating programming tasks through interdepartmental communication in order to properly maintain the development pipeline.
- Participated in a SCRUM based sprint system to get the product to release.

Santa Cruz, CA

Dec 2025 - Jun 2026

FOUNDER

FISH CORP GAMES

- Produced 3+ games from pitch to production.
- Collaborated with 20+ contributors world-wide to produce said games.
- Led Programming, Narrative, and Game Design for their release on itch.io
- Held countless playtests, from locally all the way up to GDC's Experimental Games Showcase to iterate with player feedback.

Dublin, CA

Apr 2023 - Ongoing

GAME DEVELOPMENT LEAD

Dublin High School Game Development Club

- Directed end-to-end game development, managing technical implementation and narrative design from concept to build.
- Mentored team members through technical workshops on gameplay mechanics, systems design, and debugging.
- Led cross-functional teams of programmers and artists to ensure cohesive project goals and steady progress.

Dublin, CA

August 2024 - Jun 2025

Skills

LEADERSHIP

- Vision holder who provides a clear direction and closely collaborates with teams to bring them to life.
- Recruited dozens of world-wide talents into creating published games.
- Led teams from 2 people all the way up to 200+ from pitch to production.
- Focus on team collaboration and giving everyone a voice.

GAME & NARRATIVE DESIGN

- Level design & greyboxing
- End-to-end script writing
- Weaving narratives into game mechanics
- Clear, concise design documentation
- Playtest conducting and active iteration
- “meta” / game balancing

PROGRAMMING

- C#
- Python
- Lua
- GDScript
- HTML

VFX

- Unity Shader Graph
- HLSL
- Unity Particle System

ENGINES

- Unity, Game Maker, Godot
- Game Maker
- Godot

SOFTWARE

- Blender, Krita, Aseprite
- Davinci Resolve, Audacity
- Jekyll, Github

Projects

CROWD SURFERS

Programming Producer

Jan 2026 - Jun 2026

- Managed 50+ contributors through the production of the game
- Maintained Github Project by delegating tasks every sprint
- Engaged in a SCRUM based sprint system and worked closely with other producers to maintain course throughout production
- Designed basic system architecture for early production, later delegating tasks and overseeing iterations
- Communicated with other departments, such as sound, art, and design, to relay pain points in production and delegate tool development tasks for smoother production

SORRY, SORRY, SORRY

Oct 2025

Game Lead, Programming Lead, Design Lead

- Programmed a movement recording system for the players' previous rounds
- Developed a clone playback system so that players could see and interact with their past lives
- Designed and implemented all in-game items Implemented rigorous, iterative playtesting experiments to properly balance the game by listening to player feedback
- Collaborated closely with a 2D artist and a composer to scope out, plan, and ultimately ship the game game

MY FIRST GAME

Game Lead, Narrative Designer, VFX & 3D Artist, Programming Lead

Jan 2026

- Wrote a complete, edited script for the project based on personal experiences
- Integrated game mechanics woven around the narrative, such as literally looking back at the past to reveal memories or being unable to interact with the past
- Programmed unique shaders using Unity Shader Graph for past and future views within the game
- 3D Modeled all of the furniture, environment, and set pieces for the project with Blender
- Integrated a chapter-based, dynamic music system for the project that integrated with key parts within the script
- Held countless playtests of this project at the Game Design and Art Collaboration Conference, GDC Experimental Games Showcase, and UCSC Portfolio Showcases

“LEAP DAY”

Feb 2026 - May 2026

Game Lead, Narrative & Sound Designer, VFX & 3D Artist, Programming Lead

- Wrote a complete, edited script that includes 200+ lines of unique dialogue, and edited with the help of professors at UC Santa Cruz
- Implemented a unique dialogue and item hovering system, tying into the narrative and adding a sense of exploration in a way that's rare to the Visual Novel genre.
- Programmed unique shaders using Godot GDShader
- 3D Modeled all of the furniture, environment, and set pieces for the project with Blender
- Held a social media campaign at the game's release, further boosting playtime for intended audience